



Glossary

Here are the meanings of some words that are useful for you to know when learning about the Earth.

atmosphere Thick layer of gases around the Earth that protect the planet from the burning rays of the Sun

biome Any main ecosystem on Earth with a particular vegetation and climate

blizzard A wind storm in which snow is blown quickly

cave A naturally occurring space inside a cliff or hillside

climate Weather patterns for a particular area

cloud Lots of very tiny water droplets and sometimes ice crystals

conservation Protecting an area on Earth

continent A large area of land, such as Asia

desert A very dry place on Earth. It has less than 25 cm (10 in) of rainfall every year

Earth The fifth-largest planet in our solar system

earthquake Movements in the Earth's crust that make the ground shake violently

equator An imaginary line that runs horizontally around the middle of Earth

erosion Breaking down of rock by weather or water

flooding When a river or the sea overflows and fills land with water

fresh water Water sources that are fresh and without salt

glacier Large mass of ice that moves slowly down a slope

global positioning system (GPS) A radio navigation system that enables people to determine exact locations on Earth and obtain directions

grasslands A large, open area that is covered with grass and often used for grazing animals

habitat Natural home environment of an animal

heatwave A long period of time in which the weather is unusually hot

hurricane A storm with very fast and violent wind

lava Red-hot melted rock that flows out of a volcano when it erupts

map Representation of an area of land or sea, showing features such as borders, mountains, roads, and cities

Coral reef

